

gaming with ease. In benchmarks, the X200 Pro outperforms competitors like the OPPO Find X8 Pro, showcasing its prowess in raw performance. However, it falls behind gaming-focused phones like the iQOO 13 in most CPU and GPU benchmarks, sustained performance and storage read/write speeds. While casual gamers will undoubtedly find the performance smooth, heavy gamers might experience occasional throttling and heating during extended sessions of graphically intense games like Genshin Impact.

For non-gaming tasks, the phone excels. Apps open quickly, multitasking is seamless, and the phone rarely shows signs of lag. Vivo's performance mode enables gaming at 120 FPS in supported titles like Call of Duty: Mobile, although the phone heats up slightly after prolonged sessions.

The X200 Pro's thermal management could use some improvement, as sustained workloads lead to throttling. While it's not the ultimate gaming powerhouse, it provides a balanced performance for most users, with enough power to handle demanding tasks without breaking a sweat.

SOFTWARE AND AI

The X200 Pro runs on FunTouch OS 15, based on Android 15. Vivo has refined its software experience significantly, with smoother animations, cleaner visuals, and reduced clutter compared to earlier iterations. However, the presence of bloatware apps continues to detract from an otherwise polished interface. Vivo promises four years of software updates and five years of security patches, which is slightly below the standard set by competitors like Samsung and Google. AI features, including the AI Eraser and AI Glare Reduction, are hit-or-miss. While the phone scores well in AI benchmarks, real-world performance isn't always consistent. It scored 83/100 on our Digit AI-Q test.

Look, FunTouch OS has come a long way, offering a modern and smooth interface, but there's still room for

improvement in terms of bloatware reduction and update longevity.

CAMERA

Cameras are the star of the show for the Vivo X200 Pro. While the primary sensor has a smaller size compared to the X100 Pro's 1-inch sensor, the upgraded telephoto lens and improved ISP ensure a versatile and impressive imaging experience.

The X200 Pro features a 200 MP periscope telephoto camera with a larger sensor, delivering exceptional dynamic range and sharpness. Indoor close-ups are brighter and sharper on the X200 Pro, while portraits benefit from better edge detection and natural skin tones. Both 35mm and 50mm portrait modes offer a warm, lifelike rendering compared to the cooler tones of the X100 Pro.

Daylight photography is a mixed bag; while the X200 Pro produces more natural colours, the X100 Pro's larger sensor offers slightly better detail. Ultrawide shots are more natural on the X200 Pro, thanks to a better ISP and the new V3+ Imaging chip. Macro shots also show improved colours and detail, making the X200 Pro a versatile tool for photographers.

In low light, the X100 Pro edges out in detail retention, but the X200 Pro compensates with better colours and slightly improved dynamic range. The phone excels in video capabilities, supporting 8K recording, 4K at 120 FPS, and LOG video for professional-grade editing. Selfies are another highlight, with the X200 Pro delivering more true-to-life skin tones and better low-light performance. Overall, the X200 Pro provides a polished and versatile imaging experience, making it an excellent choice for photography enthusiasts.

BATTERY LIFE

The Vivo X200 Pro packs a massive 6,000 mAh Silicon Carbon battery, offering exceptional endurance. It lasted nearly 20 hours in the PCMark Battery Test, outperforming competi-

tors like the OPPO Find X8 Pro and Realme GT 7 Pro. In real-world usage, the X200 Pro easily delivers 9-10 hours of screen-on time with medium to heavy use. The 90W wired charging fills the battery from 0 to 100% in just 45 minutes, while 30W wireless charging provides added convenience.

This stellar battery performance ensures that the X200 Pro is a reliable companion for power users who value all-day endurance without frequent charging. Vivo's efficient display and optimised software contribute to one of the best battery experiences in the flagship segment.

VERDICT

The Vivo X200 Pro is a testament to Vivo's commitment to pushing the boundaries of smartphone photography. Its revamped telephoto lens, improved video capabilities, and versatile camera features make it a standout choice for photography enthusiasts.

While it doesn't dominate in raw performance or gaming, the X200 Pro delivers a well-rounded flagship experience with excellent battery life, a stunning display, and a premium build. The refined FunTouch OS enhances usability, but the bloatware remains a drawback.

For users upgrading from older smartphones or looking for a photography-first flagship, the X200 Pro offers compelling value. However, those with the X100 Pro should carefully evaluate whether the improved telephoto lens and design tweaks justify the upgrade.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: Dimensity 9400 | GPU: Immortalis-G925 | RAM: 16 GB LPDDR5X | Storage 512 GB UFS 4.0 | OS: Android 15, FunTouchOS 15 | Display: 6.78" LTPO AMOLED, 1B colours, HDR10+, Dolby Vision, 1260 x 2800 pixels | Refresh Rate: 120 Hz | IP Rating: IP68/IP69 | Cameras: 50 MP + 200 MP + 50 MP | Selfie Camera: 32 MP | Video: Up to 8K at 30 fps | Battery Capacity: 6,000 mAh Si/C | Charging: 90 W (wired), 30 W (wireless)

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